

Akoli Speech

TERMS OF SERVICE

A personalised speech recognition application for individuals with non-standard speech

Provided by
University College London — Global Disability Innovation Hub (GDI Hub)

Version 1.5, Effective Date: 23 July 2026

1. Introduction and Scope

These Terms of Service (“**Terms**”) govern your use of the Akoli Speech application (“**the App**” or “**Akoli Speech**”), an open-source, free-to-use personalised speech recognition tool for individuals with non-standard speech. The App is provided by University College London’s Global Disability Innovation Hub (“**UCL GDI Hub**”, “**we**”, “**us**”, or “**our**”), a research centre based at University College London, Gower Street, London WC1E 6BT, United Kingdom.

Akoli Speech is adapted from the Project Euphonia open-source toolkits on Github (<https://github.com/google/project-euphonia-app>). This adaptation utilises open-source tools made available under the Apache 2.0 licence via the Project Euphonia GitHub repositories.

By downloading, installing, or using the App, you agree to be bound by these Terms. If you do not agree to these Terms, you must not use the App.

2. Definitions

“**Non-standard speech**” refers to speech patterns that may be difficult for others or standard speech recognition technology to understand. This may result from conditions such as cerebral palsy, motor neurone disease (ALS/MND), stroke, Down syndrome, Parkinson’s disease, traumatic brain injury, or other neurological, developmental, or acquired conditions affecting speech production.

“**Personalised Speech Model**” means the customised automatic speech recognition (ASR)

model created from your recorded speech data, trained to recognise your individual speech patterns.

“Speech Data” means the audio recordings and associated text transcriptions you provide through the App for the purpose of creating your Personalised Speech Model.

“User” or **“you”** means any individual who downloads, installs, or uses the App.

“Supported Territories” means the countries and regions where the App is currently available, including Ghana, Uganda, Kenya, Rwanda, Colombia, the United States of America, Canada, the United Kingdom, and countries within the European Economic Area (EEA) and wider Europe.

3. Eligibility

To use the App, you must be at least 18 years of age or the age of majority in your country of residence, whichever is higher.

The App is currently available to individuals residing in the Supported Territories. We may expand availability to additional regions in future.

4. Description of the Service

Akoli Speech is a mobile application that uses machine learning to create a personalised speech recognition model tailored to your unique voice and speech patterns. The App provides the following core features:

- **Listen (Transcribe):** Transcribes your speech into on-screen text, serving as live captioning for your voice.
- **Repeat (Restate):** Restates what you have said using a clear, synthesised voice to support face-to-face communication.
- **Type (Voice Typing):** Enables you to use your personalised speech model as a keyboard input in other applications, allowing you to compose messages, documents, and other text using your voice.

4.1 Multi-language Support

Akoli Speech supports multiple languages and is designed to serve speakers across the Supported Territories. The languages available may vary by region and will be expanded over time. Information about currently supported languages is available within the App and on the project website.

4.2 Open-Source Nature

Akoli Speech is built upon open-source software released under the Apache 2.0 licence. The source code is publicly available on GitHub. You are free to inspect, modify, and redistribute the source code in accordance with the Apache 2.0 licence terms. These Terms of Service govern your use of the compiled App as distributed by UCL GDI Hub; use of the underlying source code is governed by the Apache 2.0 licence.

4.3 No Charge

The App is provided free of charge. UCL GDI Hub does not charge any fees for downloading, installing, or using the App. Standard data and messaging rates from your mobile network provider may apply.

5. Your Speech Data and Privacy

5.1 Data You Provide

To use the App, you will be asked to record a series of spoken phrases. These recordings, together with the associated text and other usage data constitute your Speech Data. Your

Speech Data is used for the purpose of creating and improving your Personalised Speech Model.

5.2 Data Storage and Processing

Your Speech Data is stored securely in a cloud-based infrastructure (Firebase Storage or equivalent) controlled by UCL GDI Hub or its designated technical partners. Data is encrypted in transit and at rest. We implement appropriate technical and organisational measures to protect your data in accordance with applicable data protection legislation.

5.3 Data Protection Legislation

UCL GDI Hub processes your personal data in accordance with applicable data protection laws, including but not limited to:

- The UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018.
- The General Data Protection Regulation (EU GDPR), Regulation (EU) 2016/679, for users in the European Economic Area.
- The Ghana Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843), the Kenya Data Protection Act, 2019, the Uganda Data Protection and Privacy Act, 2019, and the Rwanda Law No. 058/2021 on the Protection of Personal Data and Privacy, for users in those respective countries.
- Colombia's Statutory Law 1581 of 2012 (Ley de Protección de Datos Personales) and its regulatory decrees, for users in Colombia.
- Applicable US federal and state privacy laws for users in the United States of America.

5.4 Sensitive Personal Data

Your Speech Data is necessary for use of the App. We process such data only with your explicit consent, or where another lawful basis applies. You may withdraw your consent at any time by contacting us (see Section 14), but if you do so, you will no longer be able to use the App.

5.5 Your Rights Over Your Data

You retain ownership of your Speech Data at all times. You may request access to, correction of, or deletion of your Speech Data and Personalised Speech Model at any time by contacting us. Upon receiving a valid deletion request, we will delete your data within 30 days, except where retention is required by law.

6. Acceptable Use

You agree to use the App only for its intended purpose of supporting communication for individuals with non-standard speech. You must not:

- Use the App for any unlawful purpose or in violation of any applicable laws or regulations in your jurisdiction.
- Attempt to reverse-engineer, decompile, or otherwise extract proprietary elements of any trained models distributed with the App (this does not restrict your rights under the Apache 2.0 licence with respect to the open-source code).
- Use the App in any manner that could damage, disable, overburden, or impair our servers or infrastructure.
- Record or submit speech data belonging to another person without their informed consent.

- Use the App for commercial purposes without our prior written agreement.

7. Medical and Clinical Disclaimer

Akoli Speech is a communication aid. It is not a medical device and has not been approved or cleared by any regulatory authority (including the MHRA, FDA, or any equivalent body) for the diagnosis, treatment, mitigation, or prevention of any disease or medical condition.

The App should not be relied upon as a substitute for professional medical advice, clinical speech and language therapy assessment, or any form of healthcare. If you are a healthcare professional using the App with patients or service users, you remain responsible for exercising your own professional clinical judgement and for ensuring compliance with your professional regulatory standards.

Developers who modify the open-source toolkits bear sole responsibility for ensuring that any applications they create comply with all applicable laws and regulations, including those pertaining to medical devices.

8. Intellectual Property

8.1 Open-Source Licence

The underlying source code of Akoli Speech is licensed under the Apache Licence, Version 2.0. The full text of this licence is available at <https://www.apache.org/licenses/LICENSE-2.0>. Your rights to use, modify, and redistribute the source code are governed by that licence.

8.2 Trademarks and Branding

The name “Akoli Speech” as used in this deployment, and the UCL GDI Hub name and logo, are the property of their respective owners. Nothing in these Terms grants you any right to use these marks without the prior written consent of the relevant rights holder.

8.3 Attribution

This project is built upon Project Euphonia open-source toolkits (<https://github.com/google/project-euphonia-app>).

9. Disclaimers and Limitation of Liability

9.1 “As Is” Provision

The App is provided on an “as is” and “as available” basis. To the fullest extent permitted by applicable law, UCL GDI Hub makes no warranties, whether express, implied, statutory, or otherwise, regarding the App, including but not limited to any warranties of merchantability, fitness for a particular purpose, accuracy, completeness, or non-infringement.

9.2 No Guarantee of Accuracy

Speech recognition technology is imperfect. Transcription accuracy will vary depending on factors including the severity and nature of your speech condition, background noise, device quality, and the amount of training data recorded. UCL GDI Hub does not guarantee any particular level of transcription accuracy. Not every personalised model will achieve the same level of performance.

9.3 Beta and Evolving Technology

The App may be in a beta or early-access stage. Features may change, be added, or be removed at any time. We may also discontinue the App or cease providing support at any time, with reasonable notice where practicable.

9.4 Limitation of Liability

To the fullest extent permitted by applicable law, UCL GDI Hub, University College London,

and their respective officers, employees, agents, partners, and affiliates shall not be liable for any indirect, incidental, special, consequential, or punitive damages, or any loss of profits or revenue, whether incurred directly or indirectly, or any loss of data, use, goodwill, or other intangible losses, resulting from your use of or inability to use the App. The total aggregate liability of UCL GDI Hub, University College London, and their respective officers, employees, agents, partners, and affiliates to you arising out of or in connection with these Terms and your use of or inability to use the App, whether in contract, tort (including negligence), breach of statutory duty, or otherwise, shall not exceed one thousand pounds (£1,000).

Nothing in these Terms shall exclude or limit liability for death or personal injury caused by negligence, fraud or fraudulent misrepresentation, or any other liability that cannot be excluded or limited by applicable law.

9.5 — General Indemnity

To the fullest extent permitted by Applicable Law, you agree to indemnify, defend, and hold harmless the indemnitees from and against any and all claims, proceedings, demands, damages, losses, liabilities, fines, penalties, costs, and expenses (including reasonable legal fees and disbursements) ("**Losses**") arising out of or in connection with:

- your use of the App in breach of these Terms and Conditions or any Applicable Law;
- any User Submissions, including any allegation that such User Submissions infringe the intellectual property rights, privacy rights, personality rights, or other legal rights of any third party;
- your breach of any data protection, health privacy, telecommunications interception, or confidentiality obligation under Applicable Law;
- any regulatory investigation, enforcement action, administrative fine, or penalty imposed on any indemnitee arising from or connected with your use of the App or your User Submissions;
- any claim brought by a third party (including a data subject, patient, service user, regulator, or supervisory authority) in connection with your User Submissions or your conduct in using the App.

This indemnity applies regardless of whether any Loss arises in contract, tort (including negligence), under statute, in equity, or otherwise.

9.5.1 United Kingdom

Where you are located in the United Kingdom, or where any data subject whose Personal Data is included in your User Submissions is located in the United Kingdom, you warrant and undertake that your use of the App complies with:

- the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) as retained in UK law by the European Union (Withdrawal) Act 2018, as amended;
- the Data Protection Act 2018 (DPA 2018), including Schedule 1 conditions for

- processing Special Category Data;
- the Computer Misuse Act 1990 and the Regulation of Investigatory Powers Act 2000 (RIPA 2000), where applicable to the recording or interception of communications.

9.5.2 European Union and European Economic Area

Where you are located in the EU or EEA, or where any data subject is located in the EU or EEA, you warrant and undertake that your use of the App complies with:

- Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (GDPR), including Articles 6 and 9 governing lawful bases and conditions for processing Special Category Data;
- Directive 2002/58/EC (ePrivacy Directive) as implemented in national law, including requirements relating to the interception or storage of electronic communications and the use of recording devices;
- any applicable national implementing legislation in the EU or EEA member state in which you are located or in which affected data subjects reside.

9.5.3 Other Jurisdictions

Where you access or use the App in any jurisdiction not listed in Clauses 9.5.1-9.5.2, you warrant and undertake that your use of the App complies with all Applicable Laws in that jurisdiction governing:

- the collection, processing, storage, and transfer of Personal Data.
- the making, storage, and use of audio recordings of individuals;
- the interception of electronic or voice communications;
- professional and regulatory obligations applicable to the healthcare, social care, education, or other sector in which you operate.

You agree to indemnify the indemnitees in respect of all Losses arising from any failure to comply with the obligations in Section 9.

9.6 — Eavesdropping, Covert Recording

You must not use the App to make, upload, or process recordings where doing so would:

- constitute unlawful interception of a communication contrary to the Investigatory Powers Act 2016 or RIPA 2000 (United Kingdom);
- constitute unlawful interception of a wire, oral, or electronic communication contrary to the Electronic Communications Privacy Act (ECPA) at 18 U.S.C. §§ 2510–2523 (United States), or any applicable state wiretapping statute;
- constitute unlawful recording of a private communication contrary to any all-party consent statute, including California Penal Code § 632, the Illinois Eavesdropping Act (720 ILCS 5/14), the Massachusetts Wiretapping Statute (M.G.L. c. 272, § 99), the Florida Security of Communications Act (Fla. Stat. § 934.03), or equivalent provisions in any other jurisdiction;
- constitute a criminal offence or civil wrong under any equivalent telecommunications interception, eavesdropping, or surveillance law in any jurisdiction;

10. Modifications to These Terms

We may update these Terms from time to time to reflect changes in law, best practice, or the functionality of the App. When we make material changes, we will notify you through the App or by other reasonable means. Your continued use of the App following such notification constitutes acceptance of the updated Terms. If you do not agree with any changes, you should stop using the App and may request deletion of your data.

11. Termination

You may stop using the App at any time. You may also request deletion of your account and all associated identifiable Speech Data by contacting us.

We may suspend or terminate your access to the App at any time if we reasonably believe you have violated these Terms, or if required by law. Where practicable, we will provide you with notice and an explanation.

Upon termination, Sections 5.5 (Your Rights Over Your Data), 7 (Medical and Clinical Disclaimer), 8 (Intellectual Property), 9 (Disclaimers and Limitation of Liability), 12 (Governing Law), and 13 (Dispute Resolution) shall survive.

12. Governing Law

These Terms are governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of England and Wales. This choice of governing law does not deprive you of any mandatory consumer protection rights afforded to you by the laws of your country of residence, where such rights cannot be waived by contract.

For users in the European Economic Area, the European Commission's Online Dispute Resolution platform is available at <https://ec.europa.eu/consumers/odr>.

13. Dispute Resolution

In the event of any dispute arising from or relating to these Terms, the parties shall first attempt to resolve the matter informally by contacting us using the details in Section 14. If informal resolution is not successful within 30 days, either party may pursue formal proceedings in the courts of England and Wales, subject to any mandatory provisions of your local law that require disputes to be heard in your local courts.

14. Contact Information

If you have any questions about these Terms, wish to exercise your data rights, or need to report an issue with the App, please contact us at:

UCL Global Disability Innovation Hub (GDI Hub)

University College London

Gower Street

London WC1E 6BT

United Kingdom

Email: [insert contact email address]

Website: [insert project website URL]

15. Accessibility

UCL GDI Hub is committed to ensuring that the App and all associated documentation,

including these Terms, are accessible to all users. If you experience any difficulty accessing or understanding these Terms, or if you require these Terms in an alternative format, please contact us and we will make reasonable efforts to accommodate your needs.

16. Additional Provisions

16.1 Entire Agreement

These Terms, together with the Privacy Policy and the Apache 2.0 Licence (as applicable), constitute the entire agreement between you and UCL GDI Hub with respect to the App.

16.2 Severability

If any provision of these Terms is found to be invalid, illegal, or unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall continue in full force and effect.

16.3 Waiver

No failure or delay by UCL GDI Hub in exercising any right under these Terms shall constitute a waiver of that right.

16.4 Assignment

You may not assign or transfer your rights or obligations under these Terms without our prior written consent. UCL GDI Hub may assign its rights and obligations under these Terms to any successor organisation, affiliate, or partner institution, provided that such assignee agrees to be bound by these Terms.

16.5 Third-Party Rights

These Terms do not confer any rights on any third party under the Contracts (Rights of Third Parties) Act 1999.

16.6 Language

These Terms are drafted in English. Where these Terms are translated into other languages for the convenience of users, the English version shall prevail in the event of any inconsistency.